

Bluff

YOUR WAY THROUGH

TLAs

Bogged down with TDM TLAs in computing? Have no clue what that just meant? We can't give you a decoder ring, but we do run this for your bluffing benefit anyway:

TLC

Well, the mystery needs solving. "TLA" is a TLA that describes itself—a Three-Letter Acronym, bringing the world to its knees with jargon overload.

Usage: "There are just TDM (too damned many) TLAs in the world today."

TIC

A Token-ring Interface Coupler, used in an alternative network protocol, the DIX Standard of Ethernet.

Usage: "My network is intermittent!" "Perhaps you have a nervous TIC?"

APL

C is APL. So are Perl, Python and Java. Asynchronous Pod Layers? Aggravating Pig Lard? Try the more unassuming "A Programming Language".

Usage: "I want a book on APL." "Is that a programming language?" "Yes." (*Caution:* Might cause mind-numbing confusion.)

RDB

Before there was the movie, there was the acronym—Relational Database. Oracle, MySQL, MS SQL Server—all RDBs, sans jingoism and dying people.

Usage: "RDB caused a revolution. In the database area."

COH

Used sometimes in IRC. Every once in a while, we all end up looking at new technology and talking about it like COHs—Cynical Old Hacks.

Usage: "Oh don't bother Kumar with good news, he's just a COH."

Next time you're chatting or reading an e-mail, remember to add these to your vocabulary; for the rest, DEB—Don't Even Bother.

Wild Wild Web

The eBay Department

Ho-hum. Weird eBay auctions are a nickel a dozen, but we liked this one because the auctioneer seems so sincere, it's almost tear-jerking. This in-all-earnest auctioneer offered several things in his listing, courtesy a revelation from Jesus. So anyway, what would the winner win? A *hand-written journal* listing out four "specific things," as follows. (Whatever happened to good old downloadable copies?)

1. The cure for cancer.

Some detail is warranted here—"CANCER OCCURS WHEN WE EAT OUR OWN FLESH. (*His caps; we aren't shouting.*) Two very simple examples of eating our own flesh are biting our cuticles or biting our lips. When a piece of our own flesh is digested, microscopic fragments of our own DNA enter the bloodstream..." Nuff said.

2. The precise location of heaven.

3. A solution for world peace: something to do with America being the guardian of the world and all that.

4. Know the future: "If world peace is not achieved before 2021 the world will destroy itself. ..."

Virtual Outrage

If you're a little in the fog about what MMORPGs are, skip the following. A contingent of ten thousand virtual Chinese folks recently protested against a virtual motif resembling the Japanese "rising sun" flag atop a virtual Chinese government building. The understandably agitated protesters were avatars in the online game *The Fantasy of the Journey West*, hosted by portal NetEase. One placard read "NetEase, you have even hung out the sanitary napkin." Dirty, dirty. Poor Engrish, too.

<body> <spirit>

Your Web site isn't getting as many hits as you expected. Naturally, it's not spiritual enough. In other words, your earth-bound HTML code doesn't have the spiritual touch. It's

all about Feng Shui and Vaastu, of course.

SEO is passé; Indian cybermystic Dr Smita Narang has it all worked out in her book *Web Vaastu*. In this must-have-for-webmasters is advocated the use of *Vaastu Shastra* and Feng Shui to create harmony between the five elements of nature to rope in



Rising sun

positive energies to the aid of your site.

We're terribly sorry we wasted your time with our *Fast Track* that detailed, in a shamefully inorganic way, how to build a Web site, and we hope this bit of news will show you The Path.

GIT YER MITTS ORF

US Gov't Gets Rap On The Knuckle

Every time Uncle Sam sits up and snatches Ownership of the Internet, proclaiming his responsibility to keep it clean, there is little that anyone can do but watch and perhaps make a guarded joke or two about it (*you* try crossing swords with the most powerful country in the world). But when the National Telecommunications and Information Administration (NITA) took a survey to see people's attitude towards ICANN as the Internet's governing body—their contract will end on September 30—they were in for a nasty surprise.

Out of 305 (valid) responses, an inspiring 197 effectively asked the US Government, "Who made you the boss, anyway?" They insisted that the US review their self-appointment as the ultimate authority over all things online, and move towards a more global Internet where other countries can play too. The general consensus is that there shouldn't be a UN body, rather a consortium of global organisations capable of acting swiftly.

One sore point that triggered this indignation was the refusal of the .xxx domain, something the ICANN has been criticised for repeatedly. Finally, then, some admission has been made that the Internet is indeed a global body and belongs to people in other parts of the world too (a fact we've always known the Americans to overlook).

Sadly, though, everyone agreed that till such a thing happens, the ICANN should continue its ~~reign of terror~~ democratic administration of the Internet. So basically, despite all objections, the Yanks control the world till someone else gets up and does something about it. Volunteers, anyone?

WE'RE ALL GOING TO DIE!

Women To Fare Better Against Robots

Proponents of the male side of the gender war have something to feel mighty worried about right now. Ian Pearson, noted "Futurologist", claims that when the robots come (and